

Navigate to:

HLM\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\UnreadMail

Here, modify the DWORD called MessageExpiryDays. Give it a value of 0. You can see what the key means, so set it to whatever you want, just for the inane fun of it—but 0 will, of course, disable it. You'll see the change the next time you log on.

IE: A Bad Choice For Bitmaps

You right-click a bitmap image intending to open it with Photoshop, and you see a whole bunch of programs offered to you to open the file with. Not only is it plain irritating to see Internet Explorer in the list, it also takes more time for the list to come up when there are a lot of programs. So say you want to remove “Internet Explorer” from the list of “open with” programs when you right-click a .bmp file.

Navigate to:

HCU\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Explorer\FileExts

You'll see a whole bunch of file extensions. Find the extension you want—in this case, .bmp. Expand it further. You should see a key called OpenWithList. Inside that key lie all (well, most of) the programs that will come up in the “open with” list. Note down their order, which is displayed in the “MRUList” key. Delete the program names you don't need, including, in our case, Internet Explorer.

Do a good job of cleaning up by renaming the remaining keys in order of a,b,c, etc., and then rename the MRUList.

Like we said, this is for most, but not all, the programs. Some happen to be stubborn.